

The wealthy understand this concept well.

The average millionaire has over seven streams of income, and investing has always been one of them.

It just doesn't make sense for them to not be harnessing the power of investing to grow their wealth at a much faster rate.

Having goals that you're investing towards also helps to provide clarity, motivating you to be more mindful with your money. Investing can act as a savings plan. You'll start to have thoughts like: 'Rather than eating out twice a week, I can cut down to once a week, which is an extra \$25 a week that I can add to the stock market, which alone would give future me an extra \$150 000 in 30 years.'

Your brain starts to think about future you rather than just current you, and you begin to prioritise only spending money on things that bring you value, and investing the rest. I began to experience this myself with my investing journey: suddenly updating my earphones didn't seem like the best thing to do. Instead, I'd make do with my older model and put the \$400 I was going to spend into the stock market. That's not to say we shouldn't enjoy the pleasure of the current moment, but your mind will start to shift when you begin investing. I would liken it to wanting to eat more healthily once you start going to the gym. It just becomes an automatic switch.

The benefit of this is that not only are you investing, but you're also picking up good saving habits where it's no longer about your immediate needs. There's a bit of short-term pain involved, but it really does balance out in the long run.

For many investors in training, one of their biggest goals is having a strong nest egg for retirement. Yet as of 2024, only 16 per cent of women workers say they're very confident in their ability to retire comfortably, according to the Transamerica Institute. Think about it: we work roughly until 65, yet the average female lifespan in the Western world is 81 to 85. That's almost 20 years of expenses to be covered. 20 years of rent, food, holidays, brunches, gifts for your family and the lavish lifestyle of your pets. It's going to add up.

While retirement can feel like a long way away for some of us, it's important to be aware of longevity risk. Longevity risk is the risk that your